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Wyvern

An original design by Mackenzie Bruce

Low-intermediate · 24 cm square kami recommended

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Mackenzie's second original design, created October 2026. It begins from the traditional bird base and carries his signature accordion-pleated wings over from the Flying Crane — but the head is entirely new: a crimped jaw with crest spikes, and a tail whose tip curls inward toward the head like a barbed stinger.

In his words, the head took many small folds and refolds — *"but the end product felt right."*

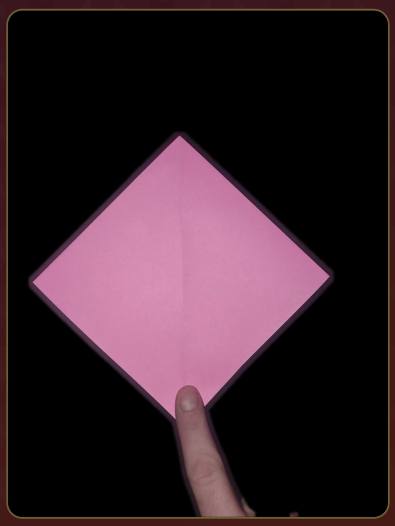
1 · The Bird Base

Every wyvern starts as a humble bird base.



STEP 1

Start with your square white-side up. Pre-crease both diagonals and both center lines, then open the paper flat again. These creases are the map for everything that follows — press them firmly.



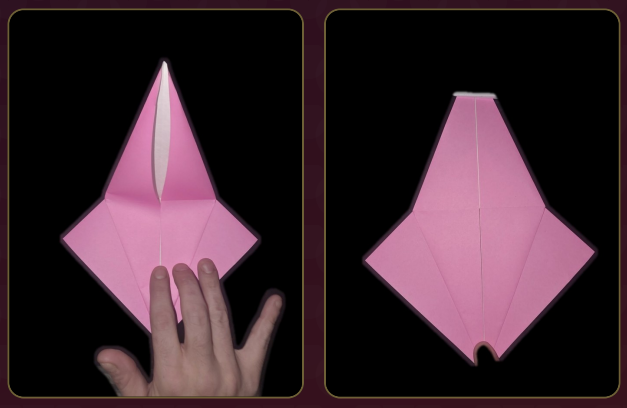
STEP 2

Collapse the paper into the bird base: using your pre-creases, bring the corners together so the paper folds into a smaller diamond, pink side out. This is the collapsed bird base — the foundation everything builds on.



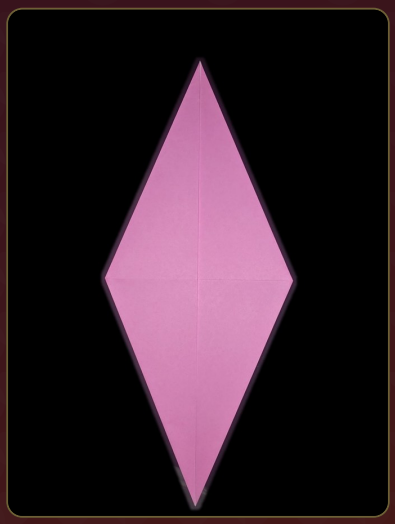
STEP 3

Collapse the paper along your pre-creases: bring the four corners together underneath so the paper folds itself into a smaller diamond, white side tucked inside. Take it slowly and let the creases do the work.



STEP 4

Petal-fold each side: lift the bottom point upward, opening the side edges out flat and pressing them into a slim kite shape. Repeat on the back of the model.

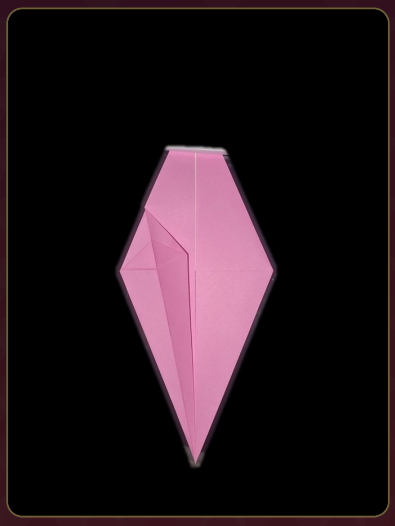


STEP 5

The bird base is complete — a narrow diamond with the loose flaps at the bottom and the closed point at the top.

2 · The Standing Bird Base

Narrowing the base into a tall, slim foundation.



STEP 6

Begin narrowing the body: fold the upper flaps of the bird base downward so the top of the model sits flat and wide.



STEP 7

Squash-fold the side flaps inward toward the center to slim the body. Do this fold on BOTH sides — the model must stay symmetrical here, as the photo shows.



STEP 8

Pull the two long side flaps out to the sides, opening the layers. One will become the tail; the others will form the neck and wings.





STEP 9

Fold the flaps back up alongside the body and press everything flat. You now have the tall, narrow "standing" bird base — the foundation the whole wyvern builds on. If you have folded the Flying Crane, this collapsed body is the same structure as its steps 5a and 5b.

FROM THE FLYING CRANE BUILD

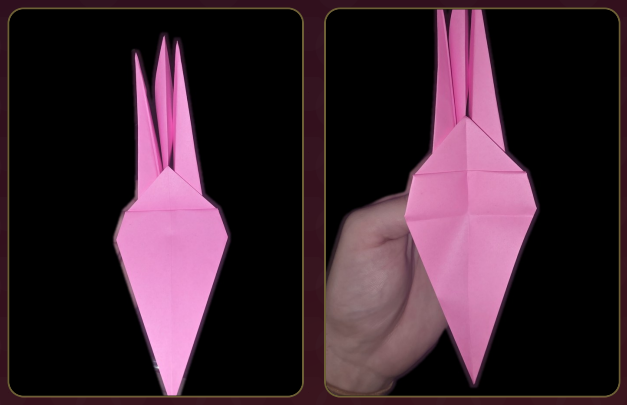




These two photos are from the Flying Crane build, done the same way here: 5a — unfold the body back to its flat crease pattern, spreading the layers out; 5b — valley-fold the side flaps inward to the center line so the folds sit up against the neck and head. The wyvern's collapsed body is the same structure.

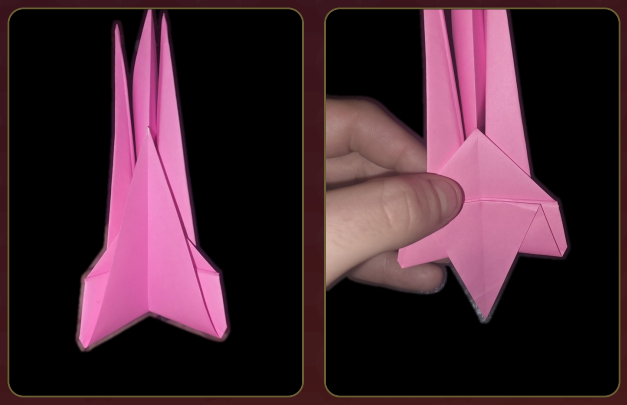
3 · The Tail

A pleated tail with its tip curling inward like a scorpion's barb.



STEP 10

Choose the tail flap — one of the long points at the top — and fold it down over the front of the body.



STEP 11

Open the tail flap out and squash it flat, then fold its side edges to the center to narrow it into a slim tail.



STEP 12

Pleat the tail: fold the tail flap back and forth in a series of small accordion pleats, working from the base toward the tip. Keep each pleat even.



STEP 13

Work the pleats down to the very tip. Seen up close, the zigzag texture narrows neatly to the tail's point.

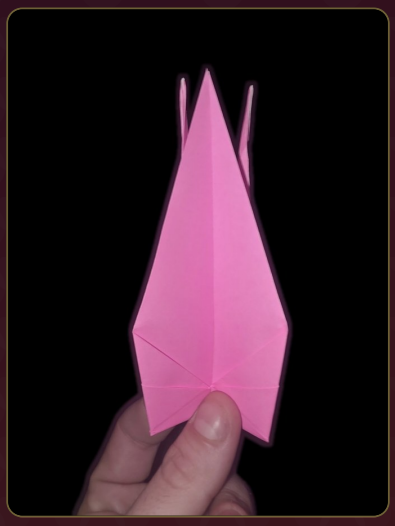


STEP 14

Pull the finished tail tip into position, curled inward toward the head like a barbed stinger — the wyvern's signature stance.

4 · Neck & Head

The crimped jaw and crest — the hardest and most rewarding part.



STEP 15

Turn the model around. The two remaining long flaps at the top will become the neck and head.





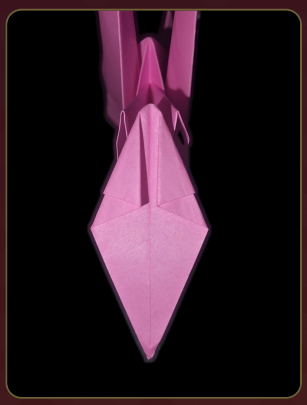
STEP 16

Shape the neck: fold and narrow the flap into a slim column, then begin working the tip — this is where the head starts to form.



STEP 17

Pleat the back of the neck: fan a series of small pleats outward along the neck. These will stand up as the crest.

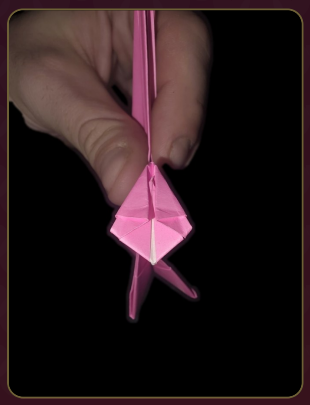




STEP 18

Form the head: fold the tip of the neck flap down and crimp it — the snout angles downward in a crimp fold to create the jaw.





STEP 19

Refine the head with small folds: the crest spikes stand up on top and the jaw takes its final shape. This is the fiddliest part of the whole model — in Mackenzie's words, *"the end product felt right."*



STEP 20

Check the model from above: the pleated neck rises between where the wings will spread, the head with its crest and crimped jaw sitting at the front, the tail behind.

5 · Wing Pleats

The signature accordion pleats, carried over from the Flying Crane.





STEP 21

Pleat the wings: accordion-fold each wing flap back and forth in Mackenzie's signature style — the same pleated wings as his Flying Crane. Work both wings to match.



STEP 22

Finish with crisp, even pleats on both wings, then spread and shape them. The front feet merge into the wings and chest on their own as you shape the wings — no separate folds needed.

A Note on the Feet

The back feet fold back and tuck underneath into a stand — exactly like the Flying Crane's. The front feet need no separate section at all: they merge into the wings and chest naturally while you shape the wings in Step 22.

Finished Wyvern

The completed model, from every angle.



Side view — crimped jaw, pleated wings, tail tip curled inward like a barb.



Full profile.



Front view — the crest spikes and jaw face-on.



Three-quarter view.



Back view — the pleated neck rising between the wings.

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Guide assembled by Muse

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